

Cafe Profit Leakage Monitor

Competitor Analysis & SaaS Architecture Research Report

Executive Summary

Build a lightweight profitability and waste-intelligence platform for independent European cafes and bakeries. The opportunity is not sustainability reporting; it is helping owners understand where money is leaking.

Competitor Analysis - MarginEdge

Strengths: Invoice processing, food costing, inventory management, accounting integrations. Weaknesses: Expensive for small operators, complexity, designed for larger operations. Opportunity: Provide simpler waste-focused insights at a fraction of the cost.

Competitor Analysis - MarketMan

Strengths: Inventory management, supplier integration, purchasing workflows. Weaknesses: Inventory-first experience, setup burden, can be overwhelming for small cafes. Opportunity: Focus on daily waste logging and profit leakage instead of full inventory management.

Competitor Analysis - Restaurant365

Strengths: Enterprise accounting, payroll, scheduling, purchasing. Weaknesses: Overkill for independent cafes, higher pricing and implementation effort. Opportunity: Become the lightweight alternative for operators with one to five locations.

Competitor Analysis - Crunchtime

Strengths: Enterprise operations management and forecasting. Weaknesses: Targets chains and franchises rather than independent businesses. Opportunity: Serve businesses ignored by enterprise vendors.

Positioning

Do not market as sustainability software. Do not market as donation tracking software. Market as a profit-leakage detection platform. Primary promise: Know exactly how much unsold food costs your business.

Ideal Customer Profile

Independent cafes Coffee shops Bakeries Specialty food stores 1-10 locations Europe-first rollout

System Architecture

Frontend: - Next.js - Tailwind CSS - React Query Backend: - Supabase Auth - PostgreSQL - Edge Functions AI Layer: - OpenAI or Sarvam - Recommendation generation - Trend analysis Storage: - Supabase Storage - PDF reports - Invoice uploads Payments: - Stripe subscriptions

Database Design

businesses users products product_templates waste_logs waste_reasons recommendations reports subscriptions supplier_imports

Product Template Loader

Preload 500-2000 European bakery and cafe products. Examples: Croissant Pain au Chocolat Muffin Bagel Espresso Latte Milk Butter Flour Sugar User selects product and enters cost.

Future Invoice Intelligence

Upload supplier invoice PDF. System extracts: - Product names - Quantities - Unit prices Database updates automatically. This may become a major competitive advantage.

AI Recommendation Engine

Examples: Reduce Monday croissant production by 15%. Milk waste spikes after weekends. Projected annual waste loss: €4,800. Recommendations must estimate financial impact.

Landing Page Structure

Hero: Stop Guessing Where Your Cafe Is Losing Money Subheadline: Track waste, uncover hidden costs, and improve profitability. Sections: 1. Problem 2. Interactive dashboard screenshots 3. How it works 4. Customer outcomes 5. Pricing 6. FAQ 7. Call-to-action Primary CTA: Calculate My Waste Losses

MVP Roadmap

Week 1: Authentication, database, product templates. Week 2: Waste logging and dashboard. Week 3: Reports and exports. Week 4: AI recommendations and billing.

Go-To-Market Strategy

Contact 100 independent cafes. Conduct 10 interviews. Obtain 3 pilot customers. Measure weekly usage. Validate willingness to pay €19-39/month before expanding features.